

Profiles & *Listings*

Show up correctly and earn the click the moment a warm prospect goes looking for you.

AUTHOR

Daris Wilson

SERIES

HMYLB · Part 3

SITE

fromthefloorup.co

WHY THIS PLAYBOOK EXISTS

Awareness gets them curious. Your profile gets them in.

Someone saw your shirt, your sign, or your booth. Now they want what you sell, so they go looking, and what they find in the next ten seconds decides whether they call you or call someone else.

Two things win those ten seconds. The first is being found. The second is being trusted enough to act on once you are found. Most local owners do a little of the first and almost none of the second, then wonder why their awareness work never turns into calls.

Findability has two layers

The **listing layer** tells a stranger you are real, where you are, and that you are legit. Google Business Profile leads it, with Apple Maps, your main review site, Bing, and your industry directories behind it.

The **social-search layer** is where people open Instagram or TikTok to see whether you are current before they commit. For a lot of buyers it is Google first and your Instagram second, and a polished profile next to a dead Instagram reads as a warning.

How much each layer carries depends on what you do. A plumber lives on the listing layer. A barber gets judged by eye, so the social layer climbs right up next to Google.

HOW TO USE THIS PLAYBOOK

Read the Complete Listing Standard first, that is the bar. Use the platform map to decide where to plant your flag. Then run the scored audit, find your lowest section, and start your fixes there. One platform built all the way beats five built halfway.

Fill every field.

A half-built profile is the most common leak in local marketing. Google itself says complete, accurate information helps you show up in local search, so completeness is ranking fuel and trust at once.

Here is the bar for a fully built profile. It travels across Google, Apple, Yelp, Facebook, and most directories, so fill it once and copy it everywhere.

EVERY PROFILE, FILLED ALL THE WAY

- **Business name, exact.** Your real name with no keyword stuffing. "Joe's Plumbing," not "Joe's Plumbing Best Cheap Emergency Plumber."
- **Primary and secondary categories.** The primary category does the heavy lifting for what you rank for. Set it precisely, then add the secondaries that fit.
- **Address or service area.** A storefront sets an exact pin. A mobile business sets a service area for the towns it actually covers and hides the home address.
- **Local phone number.** One consistent number, ideally local, that rings somewhere a human answers.
- **Website and booking link.** A clear next step, whether that is call, book, order, or request a quote.
- **Hours, including holiday hours.** Wrong hours are a trust killer and a wasted trip. Keep them current and set special hours for holidays.
- **Services and products, described.** List what you offer with a sentence each, not just a name. This feeds search and answers the question early.
- **Business description.** A few honest sentences on who you serve and what makes the work good. Plain language, no hype.
- **Attributes.** The badges that matter to your buyer, like wheelchair accessible, women-owned, free parking, or by appointment.
- **Questions and answers, seeded.** Post and answer the five questions you get asked most, so the answer is there before a stranger has to ask.
- **Posts and updates.** A recent post signals the doors are open and someone is paying attention.

Show the space.

Photos are the fastest trust signal you have, and they are badly underused. You do not need a photographer or a rulebook, you need to show the place and the people in it.

The principle carries the whole section. Show the space, show people engaging and interacting inside it, and make it easy for customers to add their own. What exactly to shoot varies by business, so use this as a starting shot list and adjust to what you do.

THE STARTING SHOT LIST

- **The exterior.** The storefront or building as it looks from the street, so a stranger recognizes the place when they pull up.
- **The interior.** The room, the chair, the table, the bay, wherever the work happens.
- **People in the space.** Real customers and your team engaging, not stock-stiff poses. This is the shot that sells the feel.
- **The work itself.** Before and after, the finished job, the plate, the cut, the result someone is paying for.
- **A few real moments.** The everyday texture of a normal day, which reads as alive and current.

LET CUSTOMERS ADD THEIRS

Customer photos are trusted more than yours and they keep the profile fresh without you lifting a finger. Invite them. A simple "tag us," or a quick ask after a great visit, turns happy customers into a steady photo feed.

Keep photos current. A profile full of shots from three years and one haircut ago tells a stranger you might not still be there.

Earn the reviews.

Once a prospect finds two or three options that all look capable, reviews decide it, and the count, the recency, and your replies all matter.

A reply to a hard review shows how you handle a problem, which is often what they are really worried about. Build a habit you can keep instead of chasing one big push.

THE REVIEW HABIT

- **Ask at peak happiness.** Right after a win, the finished job, the great visit, the result they wanted. Ask then.
- **Make it one tap.** A direct link or a QR code that drops them straight on the review screen. Every extra step loses people.
- **Reply to all of them, fast.** Thank the good ones, answer the hard ones with calm and a fix, within a day.
- **Keep a steady flow.** A few every week beats forty in one weekend, which can look fake and get filtered out.
- **Expect some to vanish.** Google filters reviews it reads as incentivized or sudden, and real ones get caught too. You cannot control that, so keep the flow steady and your count holds.

One source of truth

Write your core information once, here, then copy this exact text into every profile so nothing ever drifts.

BUSINESS NAME	
ADDRESS / AREA	
PHONE	
HOURS	
PRIMARY CATEGORY	
BOOKING LINK	

Where to plant your flag.

You do not need a presence on every platform, you need the few your customers actually use, built to the standard, in the right order.

Core · build this first, to 100%

Google Business Profile. For most local businesses this is where the search moment happens. If you do one thing from this playbook, complete this to the full standard.

Strong · add next

Apple Maps, your main review site, and Facebook. Apple covers every iPhone searching through Maps, Siri, and Spotlight. Your main review site depends on your trade. Facebook still carries local trust and events. For visual personal-service businesses, add **Instagram and TikTok** to this tier, since people validate you by eye.

Then · based on fit

Bing, Nextdoor, and BBB, plus Instagram and TikTok for non-visual businesses, and the industry directories on the next page. Add them once Core and Strong are built right.

A complete social-search presence

Instagram and TikTok act like listings now, so build them to a standard too: a bio that says what you do and where, pinned or highlighted content that answers your common questions, recent posts showing the space and real people, and your location tagged.

THE PLATFORM MAP · BY BUSINESS TYPE

Extra listings that fit you.

Start with the Core and Strong layers. Then add the platforms that match your business type, and treat each one as a listing to build to the standard, not a box to check.

BUSINESS TYPE	EXTRA LISTINGS WORTH CLAIMING
Restaurants, hotels, attractions	Tripadvisor, OpenTable, Resy, DoorDash, Uber Eats
Home services, contractors	Angi, Thumbtack, Houzz, Porch (HomeAdvisor now folds into Angi)
Beauty, wellness	Vagaro, Fresha, StyleSeat, Booksy, Mindbody
Medical, dental, therapy	Healthgrades, Zocdoc, Psychology Today, WebMD Care
Real estate	Zillow, Realtor.com, Redfin, Homes.com
Events, venues	Eventbrite, Peerspace, The Knot, WeddingWire
B2B, professional services	LinkedIn Company Page, Clutch, Alignable
Local community	Chamber of Commerce, city business directory, Black-owned business directories, neighborhood associations

Platforms get acquired and renamed, so treat these as current examples as of 2026, and pick the one or two your customers actually use, not all of them.

THE SCORED SELF-AUDIT · 1 OF 3

Grade your findability.

Score each question 1 to 5, where 1 is not at all and 5 is fully handled. Total each section out of 20, then carry the five totals to the scorecard.

SECTION 1 · FINDABILITY

1. When you search your service plus your town, how high do you appear?

1

2

3

4

5
2. Is your Google Business Profile claimed, verified, and active?

1

2

3

4

5
3. Do you show correctly on Apple Maps for iPhone users?

1

2

3

4

5
4. Is your pin or service area accurate?

1

2

3

4

5

Section total / 20

SECTION 2 · CONSISTENCY

1. Is your business name identical on every platform?

1

2

3

4

5
2. Does your address or service area match everywhere?

1

2

3

4

5
3. Is your phone number the same on every listing?

1

2

3

4

5
4. Do you work from one written source of truth?

1

2

3

4

5

Section total / 20

Completeness and reviews.

SECTION 3 · COMPLETENESS

1. Are your hours current, with holiday hours set?

1

2

3

4

5
2. Are services or products listed and described?

1

2

3

4

5
3. Do photos show the space, the people, and the work?

1

2

3

4

5
4. Is there a clear next step to call, book, or order?

1

2

3

4

5

Section total / 20

SECTION 4 · REVIEWS

1. How recent is your newest review?

1

2

3

4

5
2. Do you have a habit for asking every happy customer?

1

2

3

4

5
3. Do you reply to reviews, good and bad, quickly?

1

2

3

4

5
4. How does your rating hold up against nearby competitors?

1

2

3

4

5

Section total / 20

The social layer, then your score.

SECTION 5 · SOCIAL-SEARCH LAYER

1. Does your Instagram or TikTok bio say what you do and where?

1

2

3

4

5
2. Does pinned or highlighted content answer common questions?

1

2

3

4

5
3. Do recent posts show the space and real people?

1

2

3

4

5
4. Is your location tagged so you surface in local search?

1

2

3

4

5

Section total / 20

Add the five sections, score out of 100

0 to 40

Leaking. Awareness is walking past you. Fix Core findability and consistency first.

41 to 70

Functional. You show up, but gaps cost you. Close completeness and reviews.

71 to 100

Dialed in. Keep it living, hold the review habit, and tend the social layer.

WHAT TO FIX FIRST

The build order.

Profiles are a living layer that needs tending, not a one-time setup. Pick your tier, run the move, then come back and add the next platform.

1 Doer

Search your own business the way a stranger would, your name and your service plus your town. Fix the first wrong or missing thing you see, hours, the address pin, or a missing photo. Then claim and complete your Google Business Profile to the standard in this playbook.

2 Manager

Assign one person to own reviews. Set the habit for asking every happy customer this week and replying to every review within a day. Hand them the source-of-truth box so every platform reads the same.

3 Owner CEO

Audit your name, address, and phone across every platform you appear on, and lock down one source of truth so the details never drift. Decide which two extra listings fit your business type and assign them out with a date.

One thing this week

Run the scored audit, find your lowest section, and ship one fix before Friday. Claim a profile, correct your hours, set up your review link, or shoot five real photos. One platform, one week, one move.

The awareness engine brings people to the door. Your profiles and listings decide whether they walk through it or turn around.